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PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

Executive product management leader and two-time founding CPO with 30+ years building and scaling B2B SaaS businesses — from founding-stage start-ups and successful exits, to a Fortune 5 publicly traded enterprise, to high-growth PE-backed SaaS companies. Known for building world-class product teams, shipping award-winning AI-driven innovation, partnering with boards and C-suites to create enterprise value, and driving measurable revenue growth.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BS&A Software Lansing, MI

Chief Product Officer | Interim Chief Revenue Officer (H1 2025) 2024 – 2026

Serent Capital PE-Backed · Government ERP (Municipal) · Founder-Led Company

Revenue Growth & EBITDA Expansion

- More than doubled total company revenue and quadrupled EBITDA over 2.5 years — well ahead of the Serent investment thesis; drove double-digit Cloud SaaS ARR growth with high net revenue retention and gross retention above 95%.
- Joined as founding CPO following a major private-equity investment into a long-established, founder-led company with no formal product management function; built the entire product discipline from the ground up — team, governance model, tooling stack, operating model, and PM playbook within the first six months.
- Established a dedicated platform function delivering cross-portfolio building blocks — shared services, AI enablement, and integration infrastructure — consumed by every product team across the suite.
- Hired and developed the company's first dedicated product managers; established a Customer Advisory Board, in-app product discovery surveys, and the company's first formal customer feedback engine — driving record survey participation and a meaningful reduction in customer detractor rates.
- Drove product investments that made the cloud SaaS product clearly better than the legacy on-premise offering — innovative new capabilities that accelerated customer adoption and scaled the live cloud base; supported initiatives to improve implementation margin and lower cost-to-serve.

AI Strategy & Product Innovation

- Designed and delivered the company's first AI product strategy and monetization framework — a three-lane AI investment model (resident engagement, back-office automation, analytics & reporting) that became the board-level AI roadmap.
- Shipped the company's first AI-powered customer features, including invoice-entry automation, conversational reporting, and a citizen-service chatbot delivered through a strategic partnership.
- Created an AI-enabled development lifecycle (AI-DLC) and PM playbook and drove adoption of AI coding tools across all engineering teams, materially increasing engineering velocity versus the pre-AI baseline.
- Launched an AI support assistant in production with strong CSAT and a meaningful reduction in support cases; co-designed an AI Center of Excellence with the CTO governing AI standards, tooling, and governance across the company.

Board-Level Strategy & Value Creation

- Co-authored and presented a multi-year strategic and financial plan at the company's annual strategy offsite; developed a five-pillar value-creation framework that anchored the long-range plan.
- Co-presented state-of-the-market and competitive-landscape analysis to the board; helped define a multi-state geographic expansion strategy and the new-logo bookings engine designed to complement the existing migration motion.

M&A Integration & Payments

- Supported the Serent acquisition of Boyce Systems and led the product integration in partnership with the CTO — delivering a viable cloud product at feature parity within three months; defined the contract, pricing, and migration strategy and brought IT integration in under budget.
- Co-led — with the Head of Payments and CTO — the launch and scaling of the company's first native integrated payments product, taking it from inception to broad municipal adoption and substantial annual processing volume at a strong contribution margin, establishing payments as a core growth engine.
- BS&A named to the GovTech 100 in back-to-back years (2025 & 2026) under product leadership — the industry's premier recognition for companies most likely to impact the government technology market.

WorkForce Software Livonia, MI

VP, Global Product Management → Chief Product Officer (2021) 2016 – 2023

PE-Backed · Enterprise Workforce Management SaaS · 1,100 Enterprise Customers · 6.3M Active Users · 85+ Countries

- Brought in by the new CEO following Insight Partners' investment to create and lead the company's first product management practice as the founder exited — building the team, governance, and operating model from scratch; promoted to Chief Product Officer in January 2021.
- Led global product strategy and roadmap for the enterprise workforce management portfolio; oversaw product investments that roughly doubled ARR from ~\$68M to ~\$150M through significant market challenges, including the global pandemic.

- Created a platform organization providing shared capabilities across the enterprise portfolio — the rules engine, integrations, and common services consumed by all product lines — and led multi-platform mobile app development for business- and consumer-facing solutions serving 6.3M active users.
- Drove product investments that contributed directly to WorkForce Software's acquisition by ADP in 2024 for \$1.2 billion in cash — one of the largest enterprise HCM acquisitions of the year; participated in investor roadshows, executive meetings, and due diligence.
- Built and managed a high-performing global product and UX design organization of ~30 professionals, with strategic leadership of user research and design practices; earned Comparably recognition as one of the world's Best Product & Design Departments (2022), alongside Microsoft and Amazon.
- Built a global template catalog (developed via user-story mapping) that reduced enterprise implementation effort ~50%; leveraged AI (NLP and machine learning) to launch innovative products; managed the Strategic Customer Advisory Board and launched a customer-facing ideas portal that crowdsourced enhancements from the install base, improving net retention.
- Expanded the portfolio through M&A — supported the acquisition and integration of Workplace (UK), bringing its team, culture, and products in-house; and led the build/buy/partner evaluation behind acquiring FoKo Retail (Canada) to add an employee-experience capability, integrating its products and its founding CEO into the product organization.
- Awards: Comparably Top-Tier Product & Design Dept. (2022) · Gold Stevie, Innovation of the Year (2022) · BIG Innovation Award (2023) · Stevie HR Technology Provider of the Year (2022) · Info-Tech WFM Leader, 5x consecutively.

McKesson Corporation Livonia, MI

Director, Product Management & Innovation 2006 – 2016

Fortune 5 Publicly Traded · Healthcare Technology · Pharmacy Systems, POS, Mobile & Payment Processing

- Held P&L responsibility for a ~\$56M pharmacy-systems product line spanning POS, mobile, and payment processing; delivered double-digit annual growth — doubling revenue and tripling EBITDA contribution.
- Captured ~25% retail pharmacy market share through cloud, mobile POS, and payment-processing investment; sunset a 35-year-old product line while retaining ~70% of the customer base.
- Built an account-management function that improved NPS and retention; led the Per-Se Technologies integration into McKesson Pharmacy Systems, migrating its on-premise products and customers onto cloud products; cultivated ISV partnerships to extend the product ecosystem.

Ideal Technology Solutions · LDMI Telecommunications · Talk America Southfield, MI

Employee #4 → Product Manager 1994 – 2006

Start-Up · Application Services, Telecommunications & Technology · Three companies, three roll-ups

- Joined Ideal Technology Solutions as employee #4 in 1994 and grew with the company from the ground floor into product management as it scaled from PCs and LANs into WANs, a Detroit data center, and application services — an early precursor to SaaS — becoming one of Michigan's fastest-growing companies.
- Built a \$10M business and shifted the revenue mix from roughly 80% one-time project work to 80% recurring in about five years.
- Launched collaboration application services with DOW Chemical as first customer; ran Detroit data-center hosting and managed security services with General Motors as largest account; certified as an ANX automotive-extranet connectivity provider alongside AT&T, Bell Canada, and Sprint.
- Held P&L responsibility for a ~\$12M commercial-data segment at Talk America; created and managed the SMB commercial data portfolio, coordinated a major operational support system migration, and directed business development and contract negotiations for wholesale and resale offerings.

Further Experience: Co-Founder, Pulse Detroit and Firebird Tavern (2005–2015) — Detroit, MI

CORE EXPERTISE

SaaS Product Strategy & Roadmap · AI Product Development & Strategy · Revenue Acceleration · P&L Management · Portfolio Management · Go-to-Market Strategy · Team Building & Coaching · OKRs & Product Governance · Customer Advisory Boards · M&A Integration · Board Presentations · PE-Backed High-Growth · Agile / AI-DLC · User Research · Market Segmentation & TAM Analysis · Analyst Relations · Build / Buy / Partner · Budgeting & Forecasting · Geographic Expansion Strategy · Payments & Monetization

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Political Science · Oakland University, Rochester, MI | Language & History · Stockholm University, Stockholm, Sweden

CERTIFICATIONS & RECOGNITION

- Practical Product Management & Requirements That Work (Pragmatic Marketing)
- CPO Accelerator Training (Insight Partners & Shelley Perry)
- Global Institute for Leadership Development (GILD)
- Strategic Selling (Miller Heiman)
- Finalist, McKesson President's Award for Top Performers, two consecutive years
- Selected for McKesson's Leaders Teaching Leaders high-potential program
- Board of Trustees, Boys & Girls Clubs of South Oakland & Macomb Counties
- Professional Mentor, ADPLIST (adplist.org/mentors/joe-ross)